

CA, CS, CMA & Finance Professional Exams Guide

CA (ICAI) | CS (ICSI) | CMA (ICMAI) | CFA | ACCA | CPA | JAIIB/CAIIB | NISM | 20+ Exams

SarkariSetu India - Comprehensive Exam Database | July 2026

CHARTERED ACCOUNTANCY (CA) - ICAI

Quick Stats

3 Levels | Conducting Body: ICAI | India's top finance qualification

CA Foundation

Entry level. 4 papers: Accounting (subjective), Business Laws (subjective), Quantitative Aptitude (MCQ), Business Economics (MCQ). 400 marks total. -0.25 negative marking in MCQs.

CA Intermediate

6 papers. Mix of 30% MCQ + 70% descriptive. Each paper 100 marks, 3 hrs. New scheme.

CA Final

6 papers. 30% MCQ + 70% descriptive. Paper 6 (IBS): 4-hr case study. Pass: 40% each, 50% aggregate.

COMPANY SECRETARY (CS) - ICSI

Quick Stats

3 Levels | Conducting Body: ICSI | Corporate governance specialist

CS Executive

7 papers (4+3). 20% case-objective + 80% descriptive. -0.25 for wrong MCQs. 100 marks each.

CS Professional

9 papers across 2 groups + 1 elective. 70% descriptive + 30% MCQ. Some electives open-book.

COST & MANAGEMENT ACCOUNTANCY (CMA) - ICAI

Quick Stats

3 Levels | Conducting Body: ICAI | Cost & management accounting specialist

CMA Foundation

4 papers, all MCQs. 100 marks each, 2 hrs. No negative marking.

CMA Intermediate

8 papers (2 groups). 70% descriptive + 30% MCQ. 100 marks each.

CMA Final

8 papers + 1 elective. 70% descriptive + 30% MCQ. Pass: 40% per paper, 50% aggregate per group.

INTERNATIONAL FINANCE CERTIFICATIONS

Quick Stats

CFA | ACCA | CPA | CIMA | Global certifications

CFA (Chartered Financial Analyst)

By CFA Institute. L1: 180 MCQs, 4.5 hrs. L2: 88 Qs (item sets). L3: Essay + item sets. No negative marking.

ACCA (Assoc of Chartered Certified Accountants)

UK-based. 13 exams across 3 levels + Ethics + 36 months practical exp. Applied Knowledge on-demand. 50% pass mark.

CPA (Certified Public Accountant)

By AICPA. 3 Core (AUD, FAR, REG) + 1 Discipline (BAR/ISC/TCP). 4 hrs each. 75/99 pass mark.

CIMA (Chartered Institute of Mgmt Accountants)

Cert + Operational + Management + Strategic. Objective tests on-demand. Case studies 4/yr.

BANKING CERTIFICATIONS (JAIIB, CAIIB, NISM)

Quick Stats

Conducted by IIBF & NISM/SEBI | Banking & finance sector

JAIIB (Junior Associate of IIBF)

4 papers: IE&IFS, PPB, AFM, RBWM. 100 MCQs each, 2 hrs. No negative marking. Pass: 50/100 each or 45 + 50% aggregate. Max 5 attempts in 3 yrs.

CAIIB (Certified Associate of IIBF)

4 compulsory (ABM, BFM, ABFM, BRBL) + 1 elective. 100 MCQs each, 2 hrs. Same passing criteria.

NISM Certifications (30+ types)

By NISM/SEBI. Mutual Fund Distributors, Investment Adviser, Research Analyst, Derivatives, Securities Markets Foundation, etc. Open throughout year. 60% pass mark.

COMPLETE EXAM TABLE

Exam Name	Conducting Body	Type	Freq
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANCY (CA) - ICAI			
CA Foundation	ICAI	Professional	3/yr
CA Intermediate	ICAI	Professional	3/yr
CA Final	ICAI	Professional	2/yr
COMPANY SECRETARY (CS) - ICSI			
CS Executive	ICSI	Professional	2/yr
CS Professional	ICSI	Professional	2/yr
COST & MANAGEMENT ACCOUNTANCY (CMA) - ICAI			
CMA Foundation	ICMAI	Professional	2/yr
CMA Intermediate	ICMAI	Professional	2/yr
CMA Final	ICMAI	Professional	2/yr
INTERNATIONAL FINANCE CERTIFICATIONS			
CFA L1	CFA Institute	Professional	4/yr
CFA L2	CFA Institute	Professional	3/yr
CFA L3	CFA Institute	Professional	2/yr
ACCA 13 papers	ACCA UK	Professional	4/yr
CPA 4 sections	AICPA	Professional	Continuous
BANKING CERTIFICATIONS (JAIIB, CAIIB, NISM)			
JAIIB	IIBF	Certification	2/yr
CAIIB	IIBF	Certification	2/yr
NISM Series	NISM/SEBI	Certification	Ongoing